Michelangelo Prisciano

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Profile

Computer Science student at the University of Dundee with three years of professional software engineering experience at Expedia Group. Interested in pursuing a research career in machine learning, with a research focused MSc as the next step after graduation. Most recently, I was a research intern at the University of Liverpool in the Cooper Group contributing to Opsight, an AI lab automation platform.

Education

- **University of Dundee** — Dundee, United Kingdom
  BSc (Hons) Computer Science — *September 2025 – June 2028 (expected)*
  - Cumulative average to date: A3 (equivalent to 91/100)
  - Modules: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Multi-Paradigm Programming, Operating Systems, Vector Calculus & Fourier Analysis, Discrete Mathematics
- **University of Alberta** — Edmonton, Canada
  BSc Computing Science (incoming exchange semester) — *January 2027 – May 2027*
  - Modules: Introduction to Reinforcement Learning, Mathematical Modelling, Computer Organization and Architecture, Linear Algebra II, Probability and Statistics I

Awards

- **Level 2 Class Prize Computer Science** — Dundee, United Kingdom
  University of Dundee — *June 2026*
  - Awarded to the top performer of the Year 2 cohort (74 students)

Experience

- **University of Liverpool** — Liverpool, United Kingdom
  Research Intern — *June 2026 - August 2026*
  - As part of the Cooper Group I worked on implementing multi-modal capabilities for Opsight, a proprietary AI lab automation platform. My approach reduced cumulative regret by approximately 39% and reached near-optimal performance in roughly half the sampling batches. Tech stack used: Python, Langchain, Pinecone
  - Collaborated closely with chemists to understand experimental requirements and constraints, using those insights to inform the technical approach and implementation.
- **Expedia Group** — London, United Kingdom
  Software Engineer — *June 2022 - September 2025*
  - Contributed to the Pricing stack, a suite of 10 Java microservices with its main entry point handling 800k requests per second at peak. The stack includes SpringBoot APIs exposing both REST and gRPC endpoints.
  - Developed features and provided oncall support across the stack, using DataDog and Splunk for metrics and log search to diagnose and resolve production issues.
  - Built a Kafka consumer to process streamed events and persist results to AWS S3 using the Netflix Hollow library for optimised storage and retrieval.

Key Skills

- **Programming Languages**: Python (Advanced), Java (Advanced), C/C++ (Intermediate), SQL (Intermediate), ReactJS (Beginner)
- **MISC Libraries**: PyTorch (Intermediate), Pandas (Intermediate), Numpy (Intermediate), OpenCV (Beginner)

Projects

- **AI & Blackjack**: This Year 2 team project focused on developing an autonomous agent that plays the popular card game "Blackjack". I was responsible for implementing the reinforcement learning method using Deep Q-Learning and designing experiments to evaluate the agent performance. The full project report is available on mprisciano.github.io
- **Vinyl scratch detection**: I'm currently working on a POC side project with the goal of detecting scratches on photos of vinyl records using OpenCV and U-Net. The end goal is a fully automated pipeline that can detect also other defects and give a "rating" to the vinyl depending on its conditions.
- **TooMuchStudy**: I built an iOS app with the SwiftUI framework that records study sessions duration and provides clear stats with charts and aggregated weekly/monthly data.

Hackathons

- **Google AI Hackathon 2026** — London, United Kingdom
  Participant — *July 2026*
  - Selected as 1 of 52 participants from 900+ applicants. Led development of an app integrating multiple Google APIs to surface real-time social content trends for small businesses with the goal of offering SMEs a low cost alternative to hiring a social media strategist.

Extracurricular Activities

- **University of Dundee** — Dundee, United Kingdom
  Student Representative — *September 2025 - current*
  - As a representative I gather feedback from Computer Science students in my cohort through surveys and conversations and then meet on a monthly basis with staff members to discuss improvements to the student experience at the University.